

Safari 5.0

Safari 5.0 has been released, boasting of greater speed, a new JavaScript engine called Nitro, among other changes

Speak/write no evil

The judiciary body in the Netherlands has ruled that even speaking or writing about piracy is illegal

Agent 001

Q Suggest a good configuration for a desktop PC around Rs. 32,000, not more. I have the following configuration in mind:

- CPU – i3 core Intel
- Intel DH33 Motherboard
- 2x2 GB DDR3 RAM Kingston
- 500 GB HDD SATA
- MM Keyboard & Mouse iBall / Logitech
- B2030 LCD Samsung
- 22x DVD Writer Samsung / LG
- Cabinet SMPS iBall
- GeForce 9600 / 9800 NVIDIA

Deepak

A That's a decent configuration, but since you're not into gaming, or haven't mentioned thus, you can do better. I recommend this:

AMD Athlon II X4 630 (Rs. 5,050), Gigabyte MA78GM-US2H motherboard (Rs. 4,200), 2 x 2 GB DDR2 800 MHz RAM (Rs. 4,500), Seagate 7200.11 500 GB (Rs. 2,800), Monitor AOC 2236Vw (Rs. 8,400), Zebronic Antibiotic cabinet (Rs. 2,100), VIP Gold 400W PSU (Rs. 850). It's a much better system for general purpose computing. Just plonk in a GeForce 9600GT later and you'll have a decent gaming setup, but the board has integrated graphics as well.

Q I have the following configuration

- CPU – Core 2 Duo E6750 Extreme
- Motherboard – Asus P5N-D SLI (NVIDIA 750 SLI)
- RAM – Corsair XMS2 running at 800 MHz DDR2
- Graphic card – MSI NX8800GT
- SMPS – Coolermaster 650W
- LCD – Samsung 19-inch

I plan to buy a new graphic card based on NVIDIA with DX11 in mind. I have a budget of Rs. 10,000 – 12,000. Is it worth buying a DX11 card, will there be many DX11 games coming this year? Should I get a GTX 260? Should I get a Core 2 Quad as my motherboard supports it? Will it be worth it, as I come from a very middle class family and don't want to spend 10,000 on a processor for a mere 3-4 fps gain?

A This totally depends on you, personally I would look at my monitor first. At 19-inches, and a resolution of 1440 x 900

pixels, I don't think a high-end GPU is needed. Ditch the idea of the new CPU – it's a waste in your case. I'd go with a Radeon HD 5770, or a Radeon HD 4850 and save some cash. These cards should be priced at Rs. 9,000 and 7,000 respectively.

Q My present system configuration:

- AMD Phenom II X4 955 BE
- Gigabyte 785GMT-USB3
- 2 GB DDR3 Corsair RAM
- WD Blue 500GB
- Corsair VX450W

Can you please suggest a graphic card considering my above configuration? Maximum budget is 18k. Will I need to change my power supply?

Rohit Bedekar

A For 18K, I recommend a Sapphire Radeon HD 5850. Although invest in at least a 22-inch monitor to make it really worthwhile, else your card will not break a sweat. It should be priced at the 18K mark, and the Corsair VX 450 should be able to run it. I also suggest upgrading your memory to 4 GB, as and when your cash reserves permit.

Q I want to buy two LCD monitors. One is 15" monitor for office use. One is 22"/24" monitor for home use. Budget for 15" monitor is Rs. 5,000. Budget for 22"/24" is Rs. 15,000.

So please suggest two monitors 15, 22, and 24-inch. Also suggest which monitor will be better for movie watching 22" or 24". Thank you.

Rohit Bedekar

A For a 15-inch monitor you can go with the Acer X163w, it's 15-inches and a widescreen, available for Rs. 4,500. For a budget of Rs. 15,000, you can pick up a 24-inch monitor. I recommend the Dell S2409W for Rs. 13,200 – well within your budget.

Q I'm interested in buying a mobile for around 20 –25K and am a bit more confused as to which mobile I should buy that basically serves all my needs. As I need to install as many 3rd party application into it. I have been using Symbian S60 v3 for past 3 years now and that is the best software considering the non touch phones

as its ability to install 3rd party apps and multitasking, but I'm not fascinated by the touch UI that the Symbian is providing in its touch phones. My problem is that should one wait for Symbian^3 (Nokia N8) as the videos look promising or should I opt for Motorola Milestone (Android 2.1/2.2)?

Yesterday, I read the news that Samsung is also introducing its new s/w BADA and 2 new handsets are also coming one with the BADA OS and the other Android 2.1 and up-datable for 2.2.

I'm really a big Nokia fan. So, should I consider the Android OS?

Rohit Taneja

A Nokia's are solid phones, but I feel you might have to move on, if touch functionality is what you're looking at. If you must look at Nokia, I don't recommend a touch screen. Look instead, at the Nokia E72. The Motorola Milestone is a good phone, but the QWERTY is pretty useless. The HTC Desire is good. But I do not think these cellphones are within your budget of Rs. 25,000. If you have a budget of Rs. 35,000 or so, then suddenly you have a lot of choices – including the HTC Touch HD2, that has an incredible screen.

Q I want to buy HP Photosmart Premium C309 which is a type of all-in-one printer scanner copier. It comprises of two models, HP Photosmart Premium C309G and HP Photosmart Premium C309H. I want to know the difference between them and also the best price and the place where I can get it and your reviews. When I goes to dealer in Nehru Place on 23/05/2010 they say the above model is not available and we didn't hear about it but I had seen the reviews of it in your website reviewed on December 22, 2009.

Gaganjot Singh Virk

A I checked, the website still shows both models as active. Since they're belonging to HP's Premium all-in-one series, that is not much promoted here, it's possible these vendors don't have it. Why don't you visit HP's website and check out their toll free number for guidance, as to where you can purchase these models. Please write back and let me know what they say. **d**